

Moses said to them, "It is the bread the Lord has given you to eat. This is what the Lord has commanded: 'Everyone is to gather as much as they need . . . Then Moses said to them, "No one is to keep any of it until morning."

However, some of them paid no attention to Moses; they kept part of it until morning, but it was full of maggots and began to smell.

(Exodus 16:15–20)

self reference

Am I fine,
or am I not?
Everyday something is dying.
As I speak of this
some trace of thoughts
come and pass.
I can press on.
I wish decay was not the rule
of the universe.
Sometimes it's hard to believe
that it is all due to Adam's sin.
My neck pain
and my shrinking lungs,
my vigorous greed to be desired,
just because of Adam?
"My this, my that"
all the time
. . . come, let us fend for ourselves
for perhaps God won't . . .
Adam sins to this day
and all things groan.